

**Module 13 Lab:**

Usability Testing using Maze & Useberry

JR Clark (002035589)

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Professor Omar Badreldin / TA Karthik Kashyap

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## **PART 1. Scope and Rationale**

This report departs from the lab guide's original instruction to review all eighteen tools listed in the assigned Maze article. The instructor clarified on Tuesday 7/28 that a full landscape survey is not required for this submission, since that breadth review has already been completed and distributed in the Module 13 sample materials. This report focuses on the part of the assignment where the rubric places the most weight: the direct-use evaluation of two tools and the execution of one usability scenario.

It is also worth noting a structural gap in the assigned article. The eighteen tools listed are limited to commercial task-based and behavioral-analytics platforms, and do not include heuristic evaluation frameworks or accessibility testing tools such as axe or WAVE, both of which are standard components of a complete usability practice. As a result, the tools reviewed here measure task success and behavioral patterns, not conformance to usability heuristics or accessibility standards. This distinction shapes what "usability testing" means for the remainder of this report.

Tool selection was also constrained by what an individual can realistically execute. Recruiting external testers, installing tracking code on a site I do not own, or conducting moderated sessions are all out of scope. Within those constraints, I selected Maze and Useberry because both support public-URL testing, both allow the same scenario to be executed without instrumentation, and both provide enough behavioral evidence to support a structured comparison. They represent the most accessible category of tools for this assignment: unmoderated, task-based user research platforms.

## **PART 2. The Usability-Testing Tool Landscape: What Each Category Represents**

Commercial usability-testing tools fall into a handful of distinct categories, each answering a different question and carrying a different cost/effort profile.

**Moderated and unmoderated user research:** platforms such as Maze, Useberry, UserTesting, Lookback, and similar tools are designed to answer the core question: can a real person complete this task, and where do they get stuck? A small number of participants walking through a page or prototype with a defined goal, followed by debrief questions, highlight friction that dashboards alone cannot reveal. This has been the backbone of my own practice since 1997, when I built attendee-scheduling and editor-facing content tools for Seybold Seminars and relied on direct task observation to validate them before launch. It remains the most valuable category because it explains why users struggle, not just that they struggle.

**Behavioral analytics and heatmapping tools:** Hotjar, Crazy Egg, Sprig, and tools like Decibel (used extensively at Abbott) answer a different question: where are users looking, clicking, and scrolling on a live page, and are they reaching the intended outcome? These tools require an owned site and instrumentation, but they provide the closest thing to ground truth about real behavior at scale. They also allow teams to tie specific design changes to specific outcome metrics, which is essential for evaluating whether a change actually worked as expected.

**Information architecture and rapid-validation tools:** including Optimal Workshop, Lyssna, UX Metrics -- focus on card sorting, tree testing, and first-click studies. They are the right instruments when the research question is specifically about navigation, labeling, or findability rather than full task completion.

**KPI-driven experimentation and A/B testing** sit slightly outside the assigned list but belong in any honest discussion of what improves a website. Defining success metrics up front and testing changes against them is what turns usability observations into evidence rather than intuition. Without clear KPIs, even well-executed usability studies cannot be tied to measurable outcomes.

In practice, the obstacle is rarely a lack of good tools but organizational appetite. Marketing stakeholders often want to skip the up-front discussion of what “success” means and implement the minimum viable tracking, which later makes it impossible to determine whether a change worked. Non-retail sites in particular tend to allocate budget toward multi-channel promotion rather than toward even modest A/B testing, since there is no direct transaction to anchor ROI. My own view is that strong KPIs, real A/B testing, high-quality content, and direct user research are the highest-value combination available but they require more time and budget than a quick unmoderated study, and “fast and cheap” often wins out over “good.”

The two tools reviewed in this report, Maze and Useberry, sit on the accessible end of that spectrum. They allow a single student to execute a realistic scenario without instrumentation, and they provide enough behavioral evidence to support a meaningful comparison within the constraints of this assignment.

### **PART 3. Direct Use of Maze and Useberry**

**Maze** provided a straightforward, frictionless workflow for creating and executing an unmoderated usability test. After logging in, I was able to create a new project immediately without any workspace-creation overhead. Maze’s interface is minimalist, and the dashboard does not display a logo or branding elements; orientation comes from the URL bar and the project structure rather than visual identity.

For the initial scenario (“Find the hours for the Oakland Main Library”), Maze successfully loaded the Oakland Public Library website and allowed me to configure the task, define the success condition, preview the study, and run it. Maze’s preview mode opens the target website directly rather than embedding it, which allowed the dynamic ZIP-code flow to function normally. The platform displayed the live site during preview, enabling me to validate the task before publishing. Maze’s results dashboard captured my self-run test and provided clear behavioral evidence (navigation path, completion status, and timing).

Overall, Maze’s workflow was fast, flexible, and compatible with both static and dynamic public-website scenarios.

**Useberry** required creating a team and a workspace before creating a project, reflecting its team-oriented design. The dashboard prominently displays the Useberry logo and brand colors, offering stronger visual orientation than Maze’s minimalist interface.

The initial scenario used in Maze (“Find the hours for the Oakland Main Library”) could not be executed in Useberry due to a ZIP-code entry flow that produces a dynamic destination page. Useberry requires a static URL or stable element for defining task completion, so the dynamic flow could not be configured as a valid success condition.

To proceed, a task leading to a static page was chosen: “Find the instructions to get a library card” (<https://oaklandlibrary.org/get-a-library-card/>). However, even with a static URL, Useberry’s preview mode did not render the website. Useberry displayed only the task interface, not the live page, making it impossible to validate the scenario. I examined the OPL homepage source and did not find iframe-related directives in the HTML, which suggests the rendering failure stems from Useberry’s proxy-based preview system rather than the site’s HTML. I published the test successfully, confirming that the scenario was configured and accessible, even

though preview and live validation was not possible because of iframe rendering issues related to the Useberry proxy server.

Useberry's structured workflow and polished interface are strengths, but the inability to render the target website in preview and the requirement for static URLs limit its applicability for public-sector sites and dynamic flows.

#### **PART 4. Comparative Analysis and Summary**

**Workflow:** Maze emphasizes speed and simplicity. Users can create a project immediately and begin testing without workspace setup. Useberry requires workspace creation first, which supports collaboration but adds overhead for individual testers.

**User Interface:** Maze's interface is intentionally minimal, with no logo on the dashboard. Useberry maintains strong brand visibility, offering clearer visual orientation.

**Technical Compatibility:** Maze loads external websites directly, which allowed both dynamic and static OPL pages to function normally. Useberry relies on an iframe-based proxy for preview, and the OPL site did not render in this environment limiting the ability to test real-world public websites.

**Task Validation:** Maze's preview mode displays the live site, enabling immediate validation of task flow and success criteria. Useberry's preview mode displayed only the task interface, not the website, preventing pre-launch validation.

**Evidence Quality:** Maze produced complete behavioral evidence: navigation path, completion status, and timing. Useberry produced a published test link but I was unable to validate due to rendering limitations.

**Strategic Application:** Maze's direct-navigation model also opens a practical application beyond single-site evaluation: because it loads external URLs rather than embedding them, it can

run the same task-based scenario against your competitor's website(s) as well as your own.

Rather than speculating about why a competitor made a given design or flow decision, a team can write a hypothesis and test it directly by recruiting internal staff or a mailing list to attempt the same task on "ours vs. theirs" and comparing completion rates, paths, and timing. This turns competitive UX assessment from inference into evidence, using the same unmoderated workflow demonstrated above.

## **SUMMARY:**

Maze is better suited for public-website testing, dynamic flows, and rapid iteration. Its direct-navigation model avoids proxy-related rendering issues and supports flexible success-condition definitions.

Useberry is better suited for structured, team-based workflows and prototype testing. Its reliance on iframe-based preview and static URLs limits compatibility with public-sector sites and dynamic content.

Both tools support unmoderated usability testing, but Maze provided a complete end-to-end experience for the OPL scenario, while Useberry's architectural constraints prevented full execution of the original task and limited preview validation even after switching to a static page.

## APPENDIX 1: Maze Tool Documentation

Figure 1. Maze - Dashboard

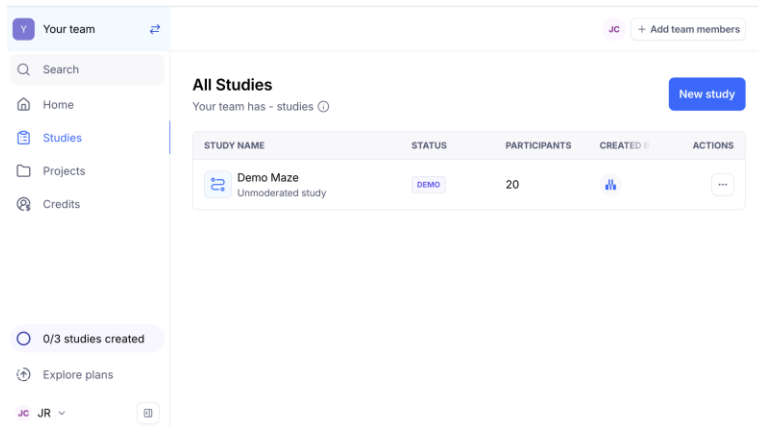


Figure 2. Maze - Creating a new study

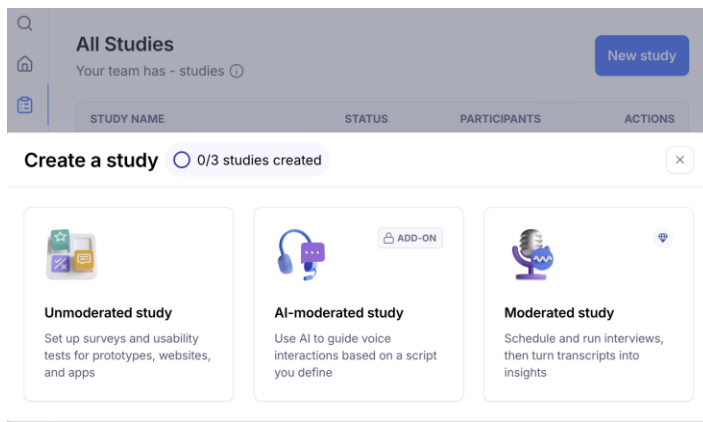


Figure 3. Maze – New study options

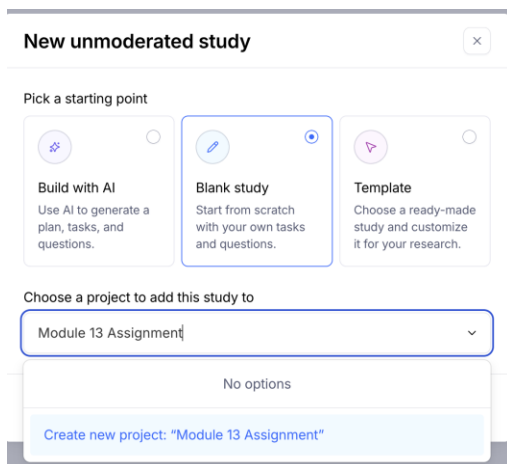


Figure 4. Maze – new study with simple task and follow-up question (see <https://t.maze.co/569168891> )

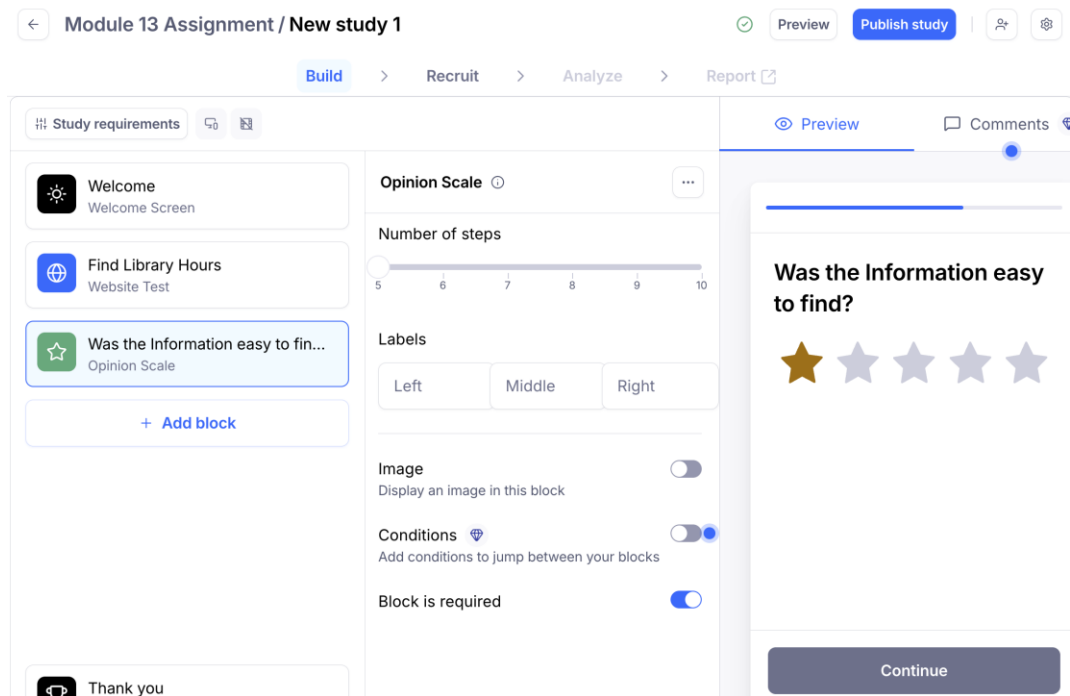


Figure 5. Maze – entering the test

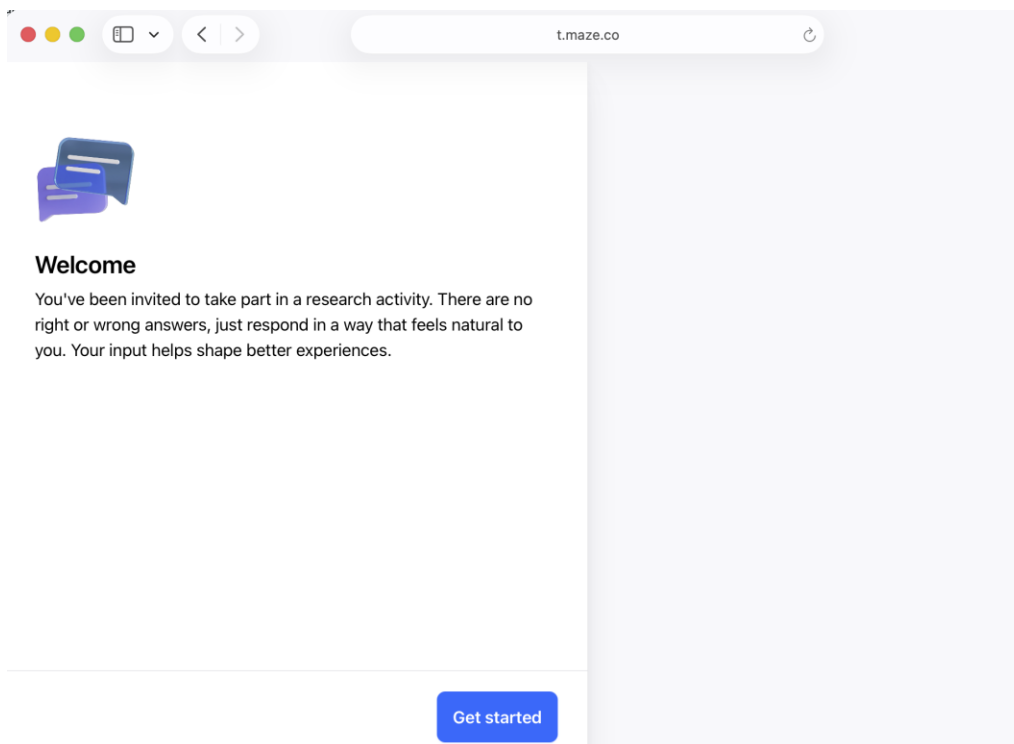


Figure 6. Maze - “Get Started” screen

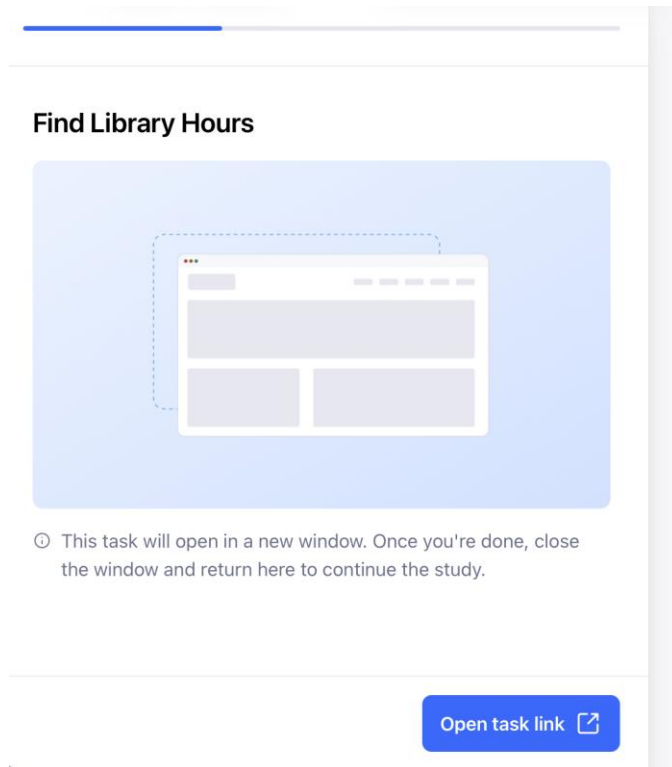


Figure 7. Maze – pop up with the study subject URL

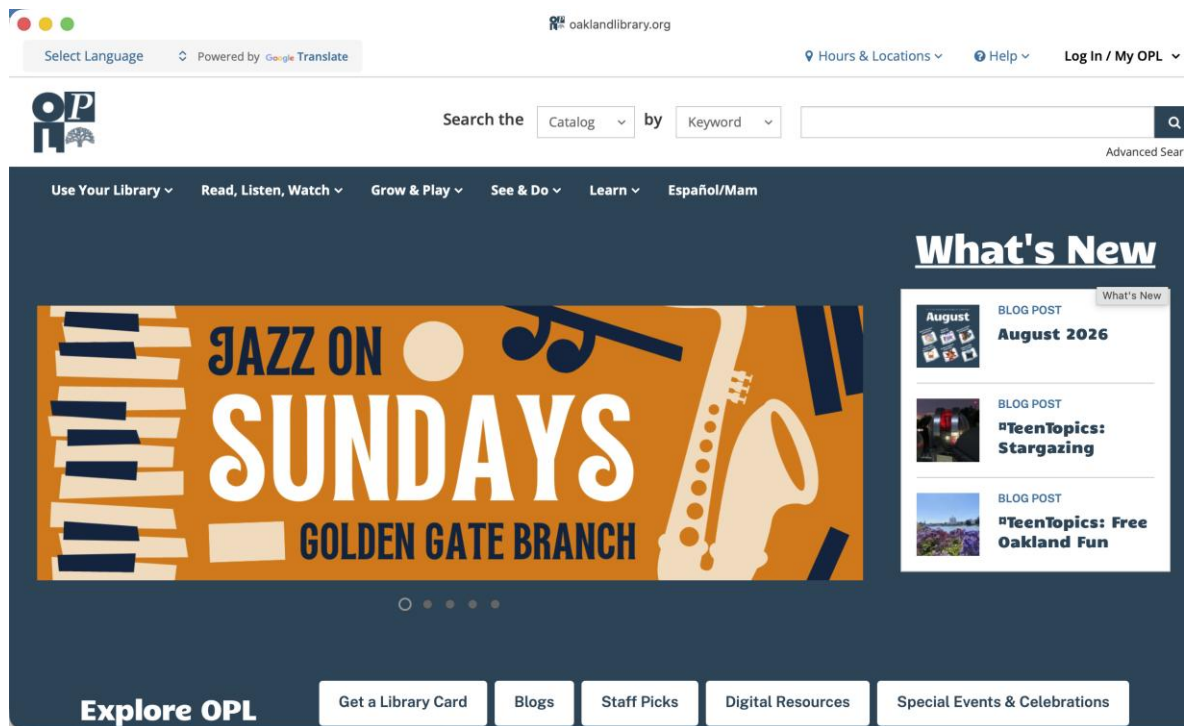
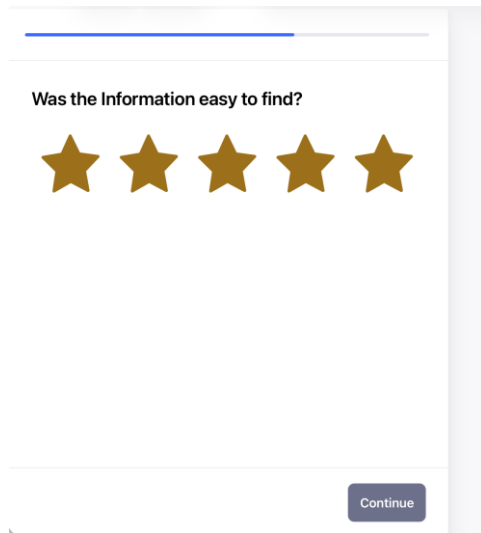


Figure 8. Maze – Rating / follow-up questions



Was the Information easy to find?

★★★★★

Continue

Figure 9. Maze – Thank you screen

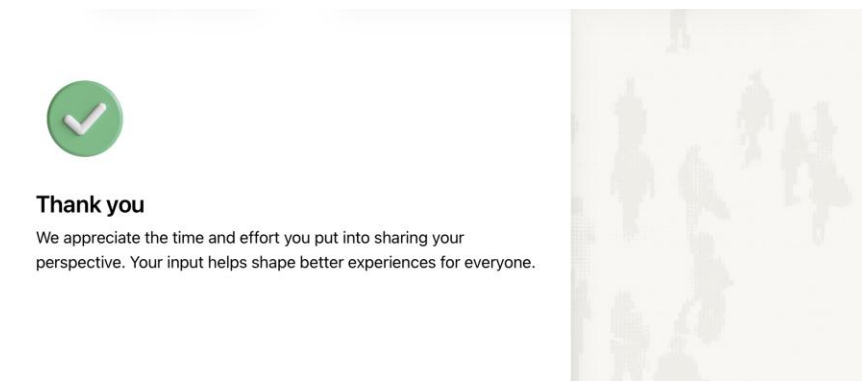
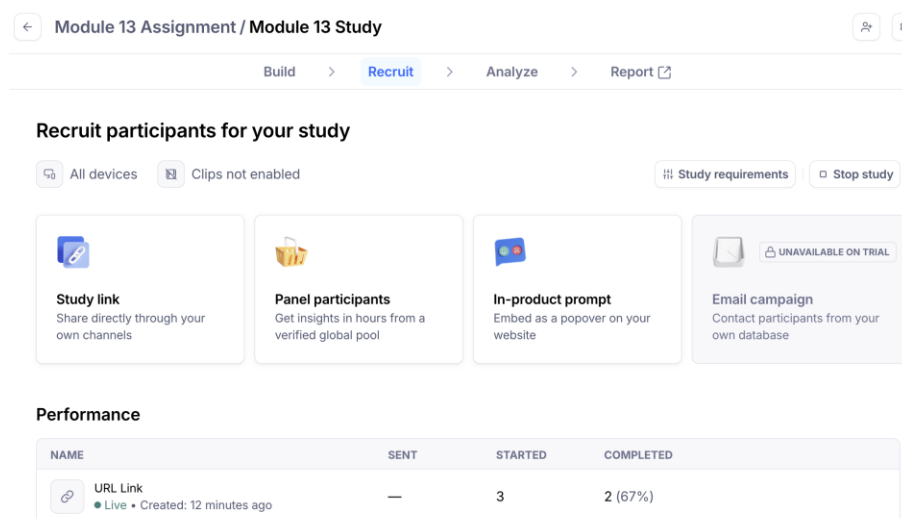


Figure 10. Maze – Study dashboard



Module 13 Assignment / Module 13 Study

Build > **Recruit** > Analyze > Report

### Recruit participants for your study

All devices Clips not enabled Study requirements Stop study



**Study link**  
Share directly through your own channels



**Panel participants**  
Get insights in hours from a verified global pool



**In-product prompt**  
Embed as a popover on your website

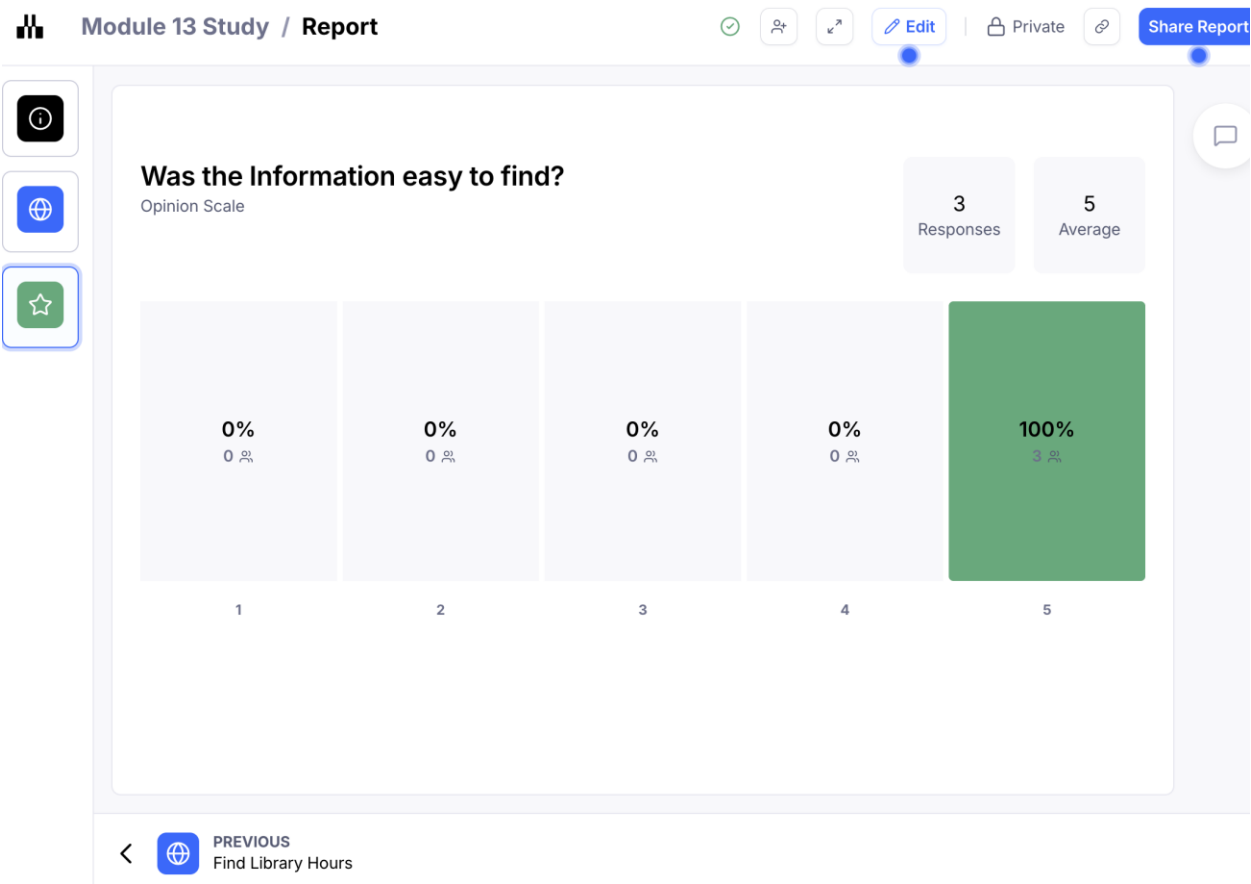


**Email campaign**  
Contact participants from your own database

### Performance

| NAME                                                                                                                             | SENT | STARTED | COMPLETED |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|---------|-----------|
|  URL Link<br>● Live • Created: 12 minutes ago | —    | 3       | 2 (67%)   |

Figure 11. Maze – Report



## APPENDIX 2: Useberry - Tool Documentation

Figure 12. Useberry – first onboarding screen

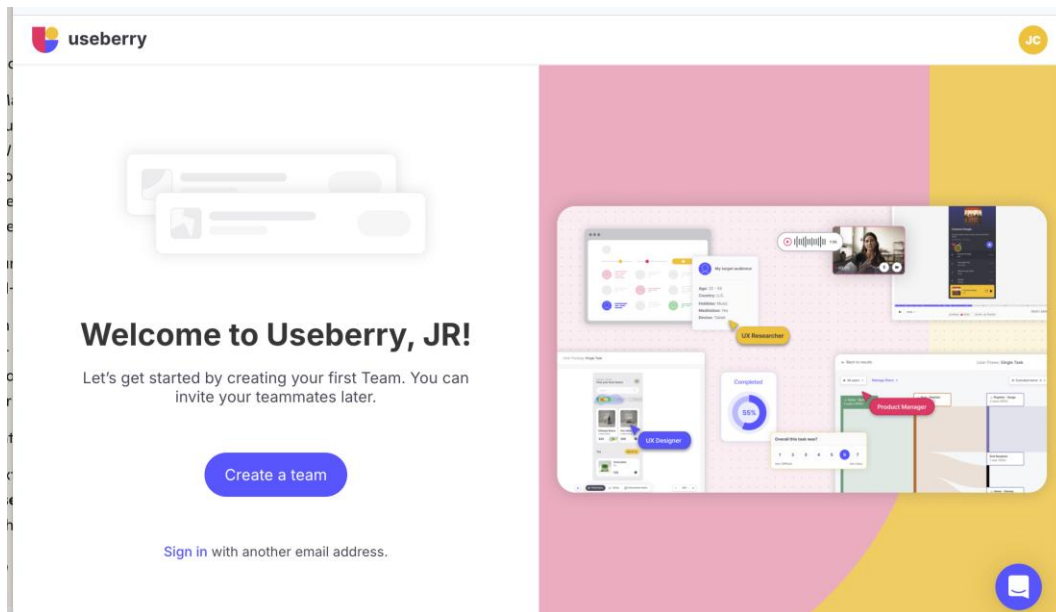


Figure 13. Useberry – new project workspace

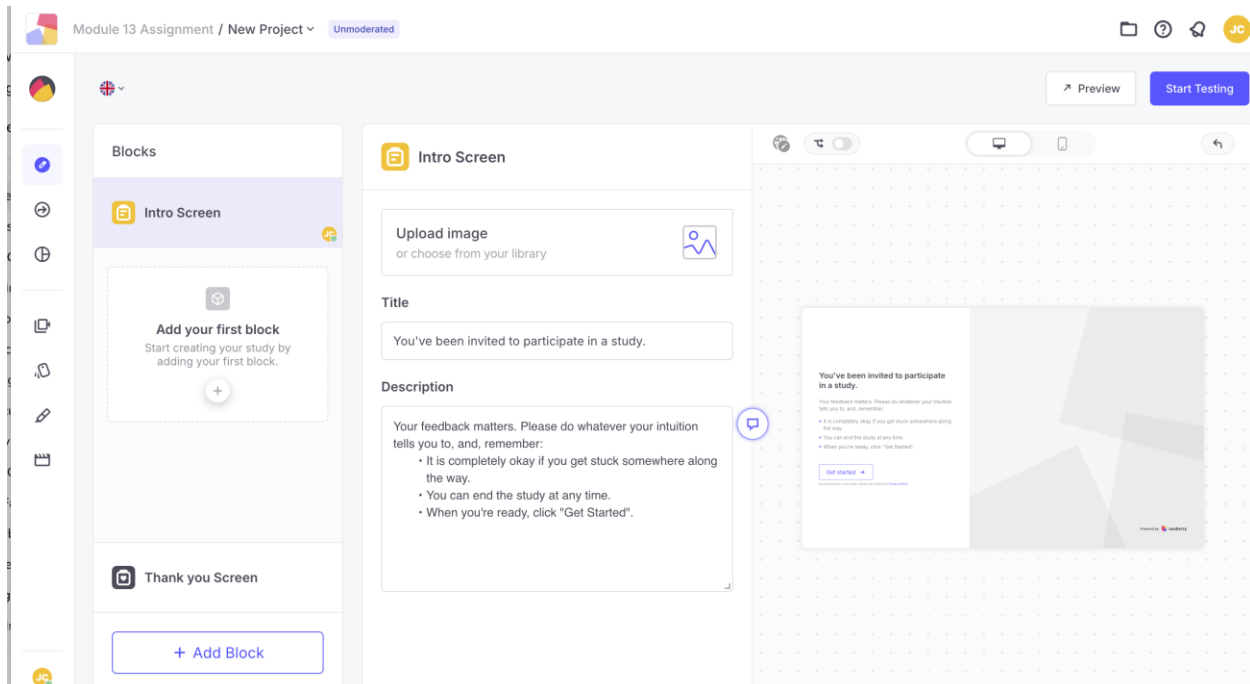


Figure 14. Useberry – Adding “asset”

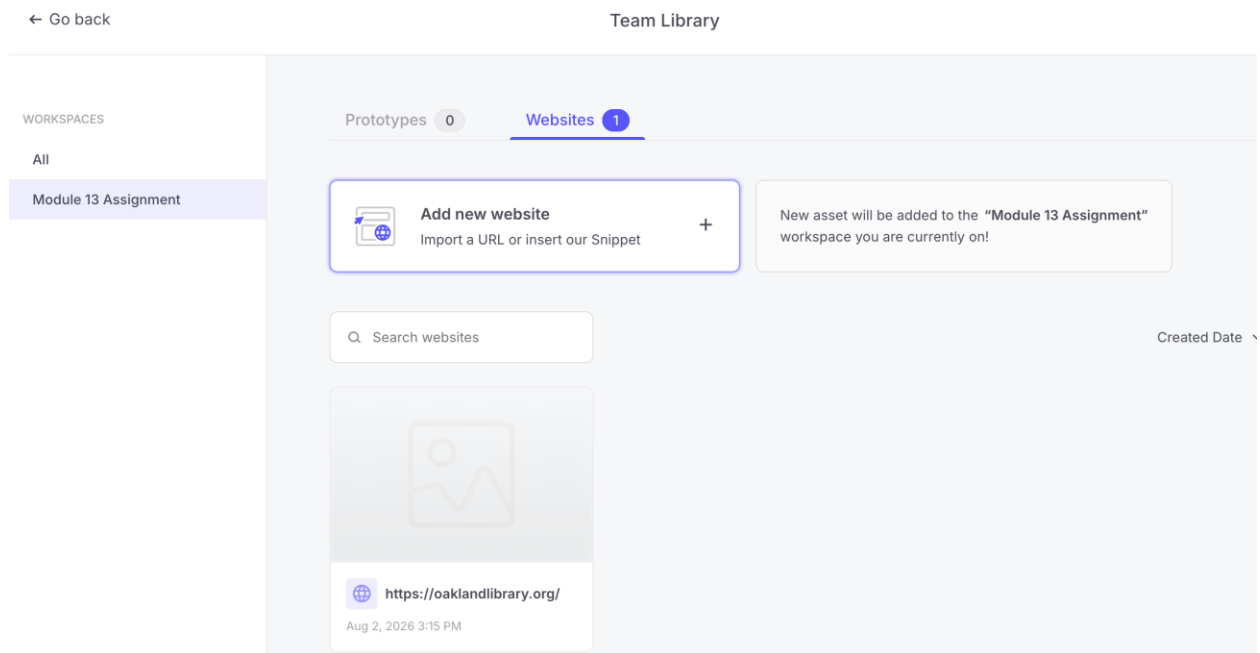


Figure 15. Useberry – Setting “task completion”

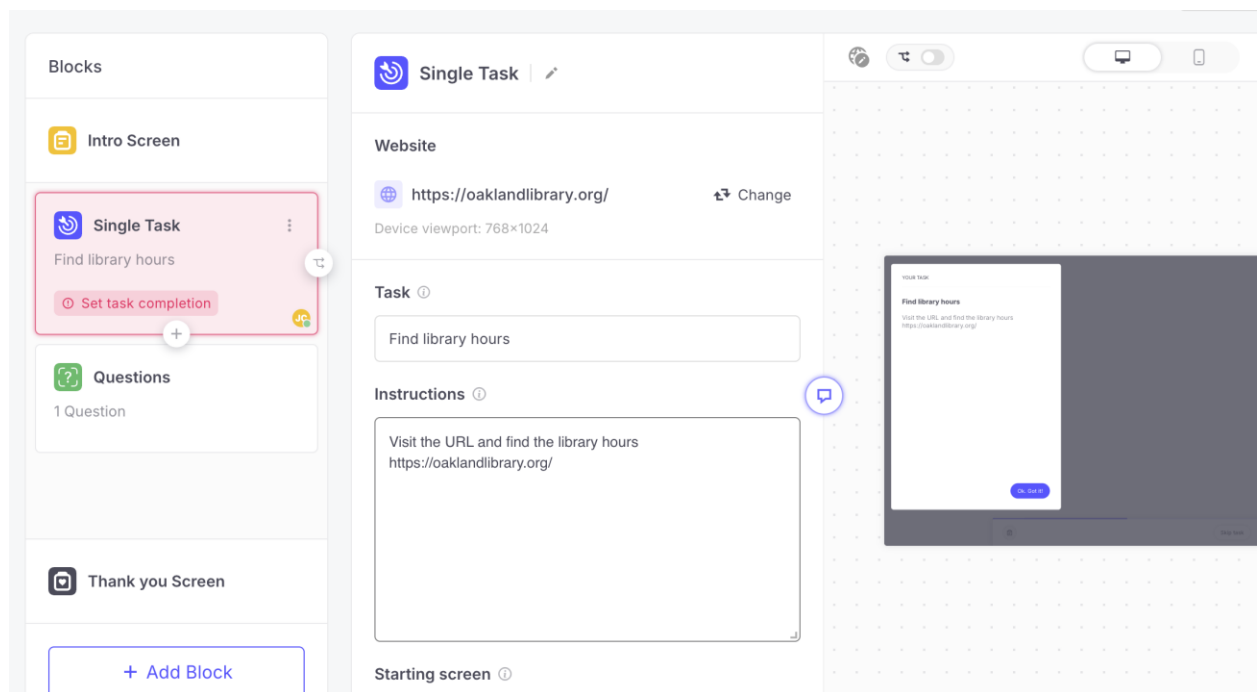


Figure 16. Useberry – Preview task

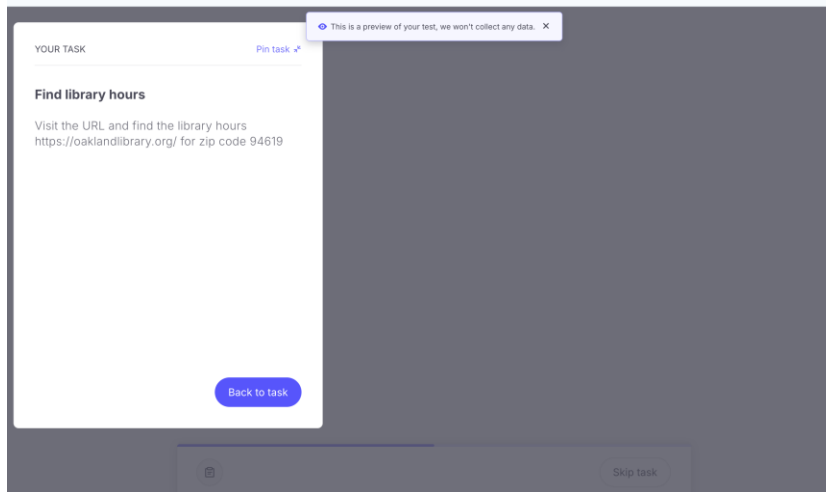


Figure 17. Useberry – Preview not displaying the web page

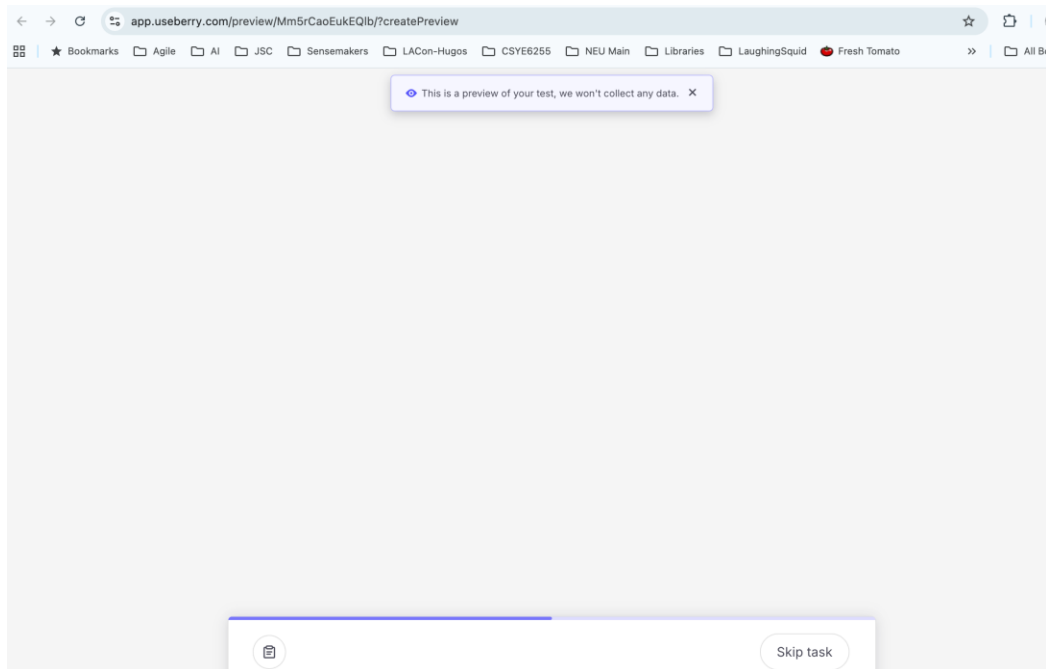


Figure 18. Useberry – Running study from the link <https://app.useberry.com/t/U6bpnlwYjUCfuH/>

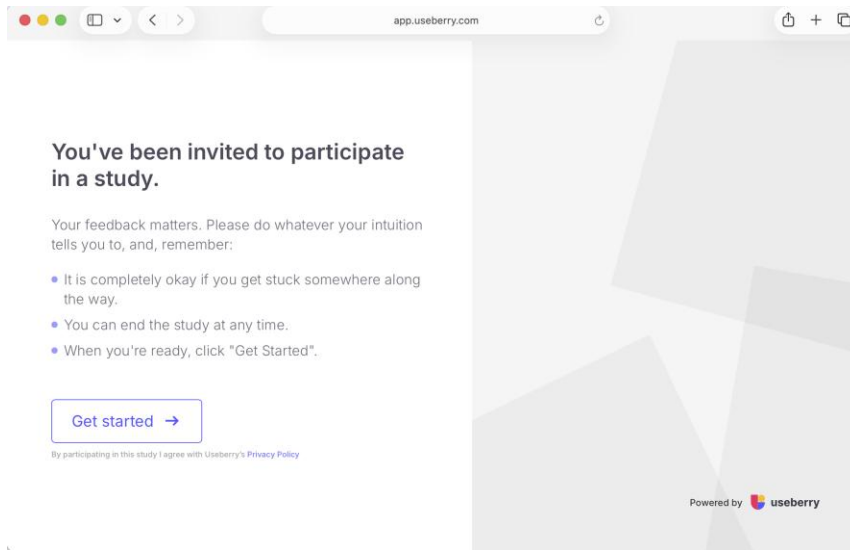


Figure 19. Useberry – Task instructions

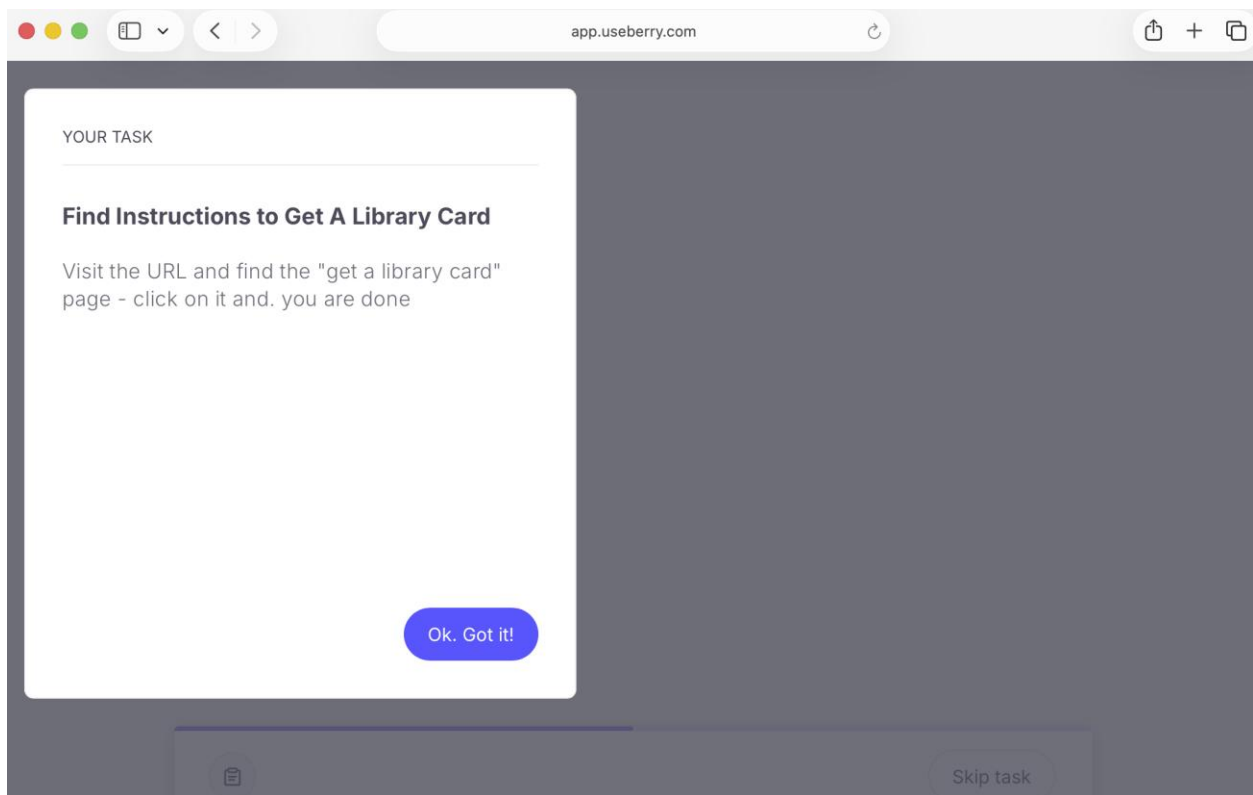
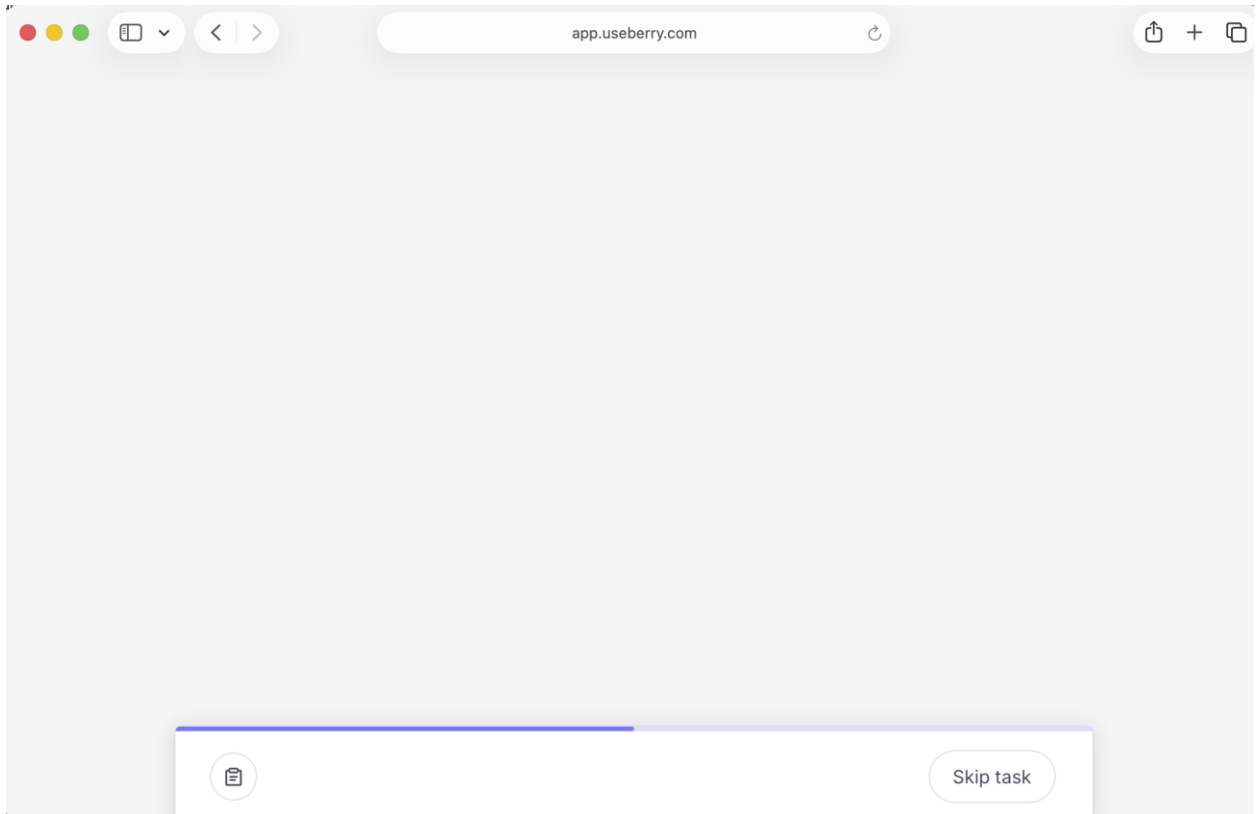


Figure 20. Useberry – Task is not showing the website



## REFERENCES:

Maze. (n.d.). *Usability testing tools: The complete guide*. Retrieved August 2, 2026, from <https://maze.co/guides/usability-testing/tools/>

## Methodology and Use of AI Tools

I relied on the coursework “Setup” guide, Class Connect and other Canvas & Coursera materials for CSYE6255.

The analysis, observations, and conclusions reflect the author's own hands-on experience with the tool and tasks analyzed. All content has been reviewed for accuracy and represents the author's understanding of the results.

Claude.ai draft review: <https://claude.ai/share/6db955ce-766c-4ee3-90f4-f3490acb2cc6>